Ep #6 | WTF is Health? ft. Nikhil Kamath, Suniel Shetty, Nithin Kamath and Mukesh Bansal

[Speaker 1] (0:00 - 0:15)

Instead of the good that's put out, it's that controversy that's what he's looking for. You can be soft, tender, and still be extremely confident. Is that what you think of yourself?

Soft, tender, but extremely confident?

[Speaker 3] (0:16 - 0:24)

Alcohol, you know, I think it's been marketed all too well. Especially wine is good for you, kind of marketing last 20 years. It's absolutely bogus, there's no truth to it whatsoever.

[Speaker 1] (0:24 - 0:31)

My life is dictated less by my timings, but more by the timings of financial events happening in stock markets.

[Speaker 2] (0:31 - 0:34)

Everybody says overall health, overall health, and overall health.

[Speaker 1] (0:47 - 1:13)

Okay guys, welcome to another episode of our podcast, which was an experiment. To begin with, I think we have three new people today. Nitin does not need to introduce himself to me, but it'll be nice if each of you can say two or three minutes about your life.

None of you need an introduction. No one more than you, I think the entire world knows you. But still, maybe two minutes, starting with Mukesh.

[Speaker 3] (1:14 - 1:21)

Okay, hello, thank you. Happy to be here. I'm Mukesh, I grew up in a small town, Haridwar.

[Speaker 1] (1:21 - 1:26)

Don't give us like the school interview kind of thing.

[Speaker 3] (1:27 - 1:30)

You tell me, what should I say? You ask, it's better.

[Speaker 1] (1:30 - 1:45)

It's good, right? So tell me, when did you come to Bangalore? In Bangalore, what is the most fun thing you've discovered about Bangalore?

Who are your friends in Bangalore, and what do you do on weekends in Bangalore?

[Speaker 3] (1:46 - 2:33)

Wow, I never thought about that. Bangalore, I came here in 2007, with the aspiration of starting a startup. I was in Bay Area before, and trying to do a startup for 10 years, didn't work.

So I figured, it's very competitive in Silicon Valley, it's not happening here, let's go to India and try. Came here, the environment was amazing. There was a lot of startup vibes.

I think you guys are the early pioneers, you started way back, I think, before 2007. But that opportunity to create a startup in Bangalore in 2007, what brought me here. What I liked about Bangalore is the weather.

I think all of us love Bangalore weather. 10 months out of 12 months is in 20s, so I love that. All the lakes in Bangalore.

I've always been very active, so I like going to all these lakes for walks.

[Speaker 1] (2:33 - 2:33)

Where are the lakes?

[Speaker 3] (2:33 - 3:11)

Which lakes are you talking about? Harloor Lake, Kaikondra Halli Lake, and many others, I should remember names. But there are these nice beautiful tracks.

There are 2km runs, so I've had countless walks and runs, and long distance running around that. In the weekends, I'm a startup person, so I end up working unfortunately. But weekend morning, I'm generally in the gym, working out.

Evening, spending time with my kids. I've always played sports, so I try to find time to play some sports, badminton, tennis. I was an avid golfer for 5-6 years.

So there was an obsessive phase of golf, mostly at Clover Greens in the south side of Bangalore.

[Speaker 1] (3:11 - 3:21)

We all know you for Mintra, and then after that we know you for Cult. Tell us a bit about how Mintra came about, and then how Cult came about.

[Speaker 3] (3:21 - 4:39)

Both were kind of accidents. Mintra, we were trying to do something very niche. Early on, we used to sell personalized t-shirts online.

When there was nobody online, nobody wanted to buy personalized t-shirts. Definitely not online. We did that for 3-4 years, bounced around, tried a lot of experiments.

But eventually we stumbled into fashion as a category. Long story, maybe I'll cover that a bit later. In 2011, we pivoted into fashion.

Finally, after 4 years of trying, we were in the right place, right time. Things started to take off. Went really well.

I think in 3-4 years, we were the largest fashion retailer in the country. In 2014, merged with Flipkart. At some point, I decided to move on from Flipkart.

It's been 9 years doing retail for me. I wanted to do something new and different. So I thought deeply about what will I enjoy doing the most.

And also what I thought could be an opportunity for the future. In 2016, I could see a lot of signs that health awareness is increasing. But there are no really good solutions at scale.

And that's basically started the CureFit journey. We've gone through multiple things. But eventually, I think we ended up building a highly different, unique product in CULT.

Today, we are by far the largest fitness chain in the country. I've had tremendous fun doing that. Super.

Thank you. Anna, next?

[Speaker 1] (4:40 - 4:41)

Who do you want to know?

[Speaker 2] (4:41 - 4:43)

When did I come to Bangalore?

[Speaker 1] (4:43 - 6:04)

I was born in Bangalore and then I went to Mumbai. Thank you, firstly, for flying down to Bangalore. It's very kind.

I have a few stories with Anna. I think the one time when we really connected and spoke a lot was that time in London. We had met a couple of times before.

But Anna's son, can I say that? Anna's son is dating the daughter of a friend of mine. So I was at

my friend's place having lunch.

And I didn't really know that they were all going to be there and that they were dating. And then comes in Anna with his son and my friend's daughter. And we hung out for a bit.

And we made plans and we caught up after that and all of that. The one thing about you which I should say is very, very endearing is the way you treat this 20 to 35 year age group, bracket guys and girls. I think amongst the people I know, there's Anil, Shetty, there's all these people who treat you as a friend and you're able to be with them, hang out with them and be amongst them like you belong in that group.

Which I think is really hard. So start from there and tell us a little bit about yourself.

[Speaker 2] (6:04 - 8:59)

Thank you for that though. But yeah, I guess I do because I connect with them. Generally for me, it's my fitness journey that helps connect.

Because somewhere down the line, they see dad at home and then suddenly see me and they believe, why isn't dad like this? When he can easily be like that. And that's where it starts from.

So I think it's that respect for someone who's healthy even though he's in his 60s is where I connect. And then I like to listen. And kids like you who achieve so much, there's a feeling of pride every time I end up meeting you, talking to you, listening to your stories.

And I believe that impossible is genuinely nothing. He says he was in the valley. Everybody believes the valley is the place where lives change and destinies change.

And suddenly you have someone who comes in here, moves from fashion, then gets into fitness and has changed that journey. And I still remember when somebody told me about Cult and Mukesh taking over. I said, this is the place to be in and the right place.

And then comes the pandemic. People don't know how to hold on to it. And they said, the business of gyms is over.

Everything is over. But then post-pandemic, it's wellness takes over completely. It's not just fitness, wellness.

So I think for me, my journey connects to all this and the youth is because I started off as an actor, not believing that I was going to get an opportunity. The South Indian boy there doesn't speak the language. Of course, I spoke Hindi in school.

But I managed to get through, you know, probably 40, 45 out of 100 when it came to Hindi. My diction was never very good because we spoke Tulu at home. We never spoke Hindi, not a word of Hindi at home.

So when I got into the business of cinema, thanks to my martial arts background, I believed that I was going to be successful, like probably a Mr. Bachchan would. But then when the results come out, you see success at the box office, but you have a critique writing you off completely and saying you're And reality hits you so hard, you don't know what to do. Take a step back and then decide, you know what, the only way I can stay here is if I create an image for myself.

What is my strength? Action. Work on it.

But there are a lot of others who are doing action too. Then do death-defying stunts. Take that risk, let that family not know.

But go every morning to do action, believing that either you're going to come back with a broken bone or you're not going to come back at all. It's a tough job. It is a very tough job.

Being an action hero is a very, very tough job.

[Speaker 1] (8:59 - 9:12)

I say that like all of us. Where we go to work and in a way we earn a wage periodically. You guys put in all the work and you have your result on one day.

It's like writing an exam every year.

[Speaker 2] (9:12 - 9:48)

True, and other than that, people believe that it's a very glamorous world. Glamour is only because you're on screen and there's extra love for you. Other than that, it is hard work.

It's constant pressure. Today, the mobile phone. Whatever you do, every action of mine is being captured.

And the way the virtual world is going, it's never the good that's put out. It's that controversy that's put out. That's what he's looking for.

That's where he began. He took a pot shot at you.

[Speaker 1] (9:50 - 9:51)

I just wanted to warm you up.

[Speaker 2] (9:51 - 9:57)

But he's a brat. He's a brat even otherwise. So expect that from him.

[Speaker 1] (9:58 - 10:04)

So I love doing this amongst my friends. He has seen this. So normally I will have a dinner with 8 or 10 people.

[Speaker 2] (10:04 - 10:07)

I didn't mind at all. I didn't get into the detail.

[Speaker 1] (10:07 - 10:09)

That's what he's trying to say.

[Speaker 2] (10:14 - 10:32)

Let me introduce him. What I heard about him before I came here was even his 8 year old flips a packet of food and checks what the ingredients are. How much fat, how much protein, how much what.

And he's an obsessive fitness guy.

[Speaker 1] (10:33 - 14:48)

Luckily for us, me and Nitin have shared a bedroom for maybe like 16-17 years of my life. And we've eaten the same food. We've shared the same clothes.

So if he's saying any bullshit about his fitness routine, I'm here. Where do I start? So our dad was in the bank.

And he took us around the country. We came to Bangalore in 1996. I did my school here.

I went to an engineering college. I took telecommunication engineering. The first year was all these common physics, chemistry, maths.

The third semester, the first class I went in, they were trying to teach signals and systems. And all these waves. I was like, dude, what's happening?

That was really the last I saw of my college. And I got introduced to trading the markets. I started trading.

To make the money, I did a bunch of things. Back in the day, I used to work in these weekend showrooms, etc. And then I did multilevel marketing.

So I was one of the first few guys doing multilevel marketing. And this was the late 90s. Around 2001, I went bust trading.

I went and joined a call center. I worked for three or four years. Nikhil is seven years younger.

He picked trading the markets much before I did, in terms of my age. I think by 15, 16, he was already trading. Then I worked in a call center between 2001 to 2005.

Funnily enough, we worked in the same call center, but at different times. I was there in 2003. He quit that one in 2001.

This is 24-7, customer.com. I was among the first few guys to join this call center. I think Nikhil joined later.

It was a really fun place. Terrible pay, no money, horrible night shift. But for the couple of years that I was there, I had so much fun.

I learned all my life skills really in the call center. Because there was selling on the phone. I think looking back, the real skill set that I've learned in my life is selling on the phone.

Just being able to sell. Because even today, as a businessman, you're constantly selling. You're constantly saying something which can help you sell something.

So yeah, anyway, 2005, I quit. I became a franchisee of a bigger brokerage firm. I think Nikhil quit in 2006, 2007.

He joined. I quickly realized that Nikhil is a better trader than I am. Because at that point of time, we were trading with the money.

And I was also doing this side hustle of doing some broking business. Then in 2008-2009, he said, if he's better than me in trading, why not he continue trading? And maybe I can go do broking permanently.

So 2010, we started Zaroda. It was not meant to be what it is today. I still remember the first email I had sent.

I said, if we can get to 10,000 customers, we have arrived in life. So we are at 1.1 crore customers today. We can't market ourselves just because it's our name.

In the context, I've looked up to you through my life. Because I've always been playing a sport. I've found playing a sport as my release.

I used to play a lot of basketball when I was younger. I hurt my knees and then I cycled for a long time. Then soccer, cricket, everything.

I remember around the border time, I became an even bigger fan. Because until then, I was a big fan of your body. After that movie, your image went from just the body to acting as well.

[Speaker 2] (14:48 - 15:29)

That took me to those first few years. Because I had not learned my craft. I got an opportunity, I grabbed it.

And didn't realize it's tough to stay out there. It was always that South Indian actors never made it in Hindi cinema. Of course, they had a great first film, second film.

But after that, you never sustained. For me, it was very important that I learned my craft quickly before I was thrown out. It's that image of an action hero that let me stay.

Got me films, I signed those films quickly. And learned my craft during work.

[Speaker 1] (15:30 - 16:06)

I think, after Amitabh Bachchan, you're the most beautifully aging actor in India. I was talking to my wife. We were looking at Brad Pitt and George Clooney.

How well they're aging. And then, suddenly you come on the scene. It's amazing.

Thanks for all of us, I think it's an inspiration. These guys have knowledge and theory about how to be healthy. You're like the specimen.

You're like Sachin Tendulkar, these guys are commentators.

[Speaker 2] (16:08 - 20:10)

Coaches? I think it's the discipline. Discipline that comes from, of course, watching your parents.

My father was my biggest hero. Still is. Nine-year-old restaurant, coming into Mumbai.

Achieving, of course, a lot of them came and achieved a lot. Because the opportunities were a lot more. But also, working in places and then owning those very places.

So that's my biggest time. That's my mantra. That's my cult.

All that I see, looking at him. So, of course, it comes from there. South Indian families, Indian smaller towns.

We grew up watching our parents rather than listening to them. But for me, it was also martial arts. Sensei Parvez Mistry, my guru.

Who taught me what discipline was all about. Who taught me what waking up early meant. How much you could achieve.

Knowing your own power and not using it. How patience. How to listen.

I think that's what the old format of martial arts taught me. Whereas today it's all about go beat,

beat, beat, beat, protect fitness. Then it was about mind also.

And mind over body. Which is the difference. And that's why I always tell friends of mine.

Especially today in this virtual world. Where kids are all on the phone. Anxious about things.

Send them into that real world. Let them do. When I was talking to you earlier, I said group.

Group is because you learn to win. You learn to lose. You learn to do things together as a team.

So, kids going out there. For me, if it's a two year old. I'd say send him to, if not a gym, a workout place.

Because he needs to learn that hand-eye coordination. That's going to help him to do anything in life. Catch a catch like that.

Otherwise you're lost. And the minute a kid you see like this. You know he's going to find it tough.

When he moves on in life. So, I think I've learned to understand the smaller things in life. I'm a good listener also.

I listen. I take in. Even when I met you the first time.

When you came with Amit. The surname Kamath. Everything gave me a feeling of home.

Everything gave me. And I'm proud of what the kids achieve. You know, I get emotional about it.

Because I feel they are our own. And then, even if it's the first time. I approach you like I've known you.

You know, and that makes things easier. So, I think the simple things in life. That one has done.

Not having a gym. But using basic equipment to learn to train. Realizing that it's not the equipment.

It's the application of the mind to that muscle. Which gives it that result and nothing else. But how do you do that over 40 years?

I think, I guess because of my passion. And I've realized that. You know, like they say.

That 21 day formula of getting into fitness. First, you feel it. And then, you know, you see it.

And then you hear it. And the minute you start hearing it. It keeps you going.

Now, him telling me encourages me to go back. And say, you know, let me continue doing that. Because if I can influence one kid to take up health and wellness and fitness.

And then go back home. And tell dad or mom. Look at dad and mom.

Dad, look at Sunil uncle. He's 62. At least try getting there.

And then they start believing that yes, that can happen. And what brings about that change? Food.

You know. That is that biggest drug also. That is being abused for anxiety.

At the same time, the drug that is not being used as an antidepressant is exercise. And we are not using that. And it's available.

So, one is being abused and the other is not being used. Yeah, but since we are talking about health.

[Speaker 1] (20:10 - 20:32)

I think one of the, in my health journey, one of the things I did wrong through most of my life was really the food. I mean, while I, you know, I think he's also been active. But I've played a lot more sport, etc.

But I remember, you know, after a two-hour basketball game, I'll go and have like 10 watermelon juice. Not one and two.

[Speaker 3] (20:32 - 20:33)

Now or back in the day?

[Speaker 1] (20:33 - 22:13)

Back in the day. So, I probably am kind of negating everything that I've done already. So, those learnings.

I mean, the funny thing. When I first went to the gym, there was no access to internet. There was no access to book.

And my mom somehow convinced me that eating ginger garlic helps you get more muscle. So, I used to go to the gym, come back and eat ginger garlic. Like raw ginger garlic.

You know, and this is, you know, in the late 90s, you know. So, but yeah, but in terms of my health, I think, Seema, my wife, you know, she had, she was diagnosed with breast cancer, you know, in 2020. And that's when I think, you know, I got in serious about what goes into my body.

Because, you know, a lot of research that went into it, you know, like saying what causes cancer and etc. And then, you know, once I went in through the rabbit hole, I was like, you know, food is

really what essentially matters, right? So, yeah, so I think, you know, what you rightly said.

I think people don't, you can't outrun a bad diet, right? And so, yes, I think I'm very particular about the food today. In the sense, I avoid eating outside food as much as possible.

I used to binge drink before, you know, like every once in a while, you know, we'd all catch up. And once our friends around, you know, it starts with one drink and then, you know, suddenly binge drinking. But then, you know, the last two, three years, all the research I've done, I mean, I think binge drink, there's nothing more harmful that it can do to your body than binge drinking.

Do you drink Mukesh?

[Speaker 3] (22:14 - 23:26)

Used to. I was a regular drinker, never really a heavy drinker, but I was into my wine. I think over a period of time, I learned to enjoy my wine.

But every time I'll drink, next day I'll pay the price. I'll have a terrible sleep. I'll wake up, you know, just feeling groggy and not up to it.

I will definitely miss my workout. And the whole day I feel like my brain is not working. I'm like this, you know, compromised, you know, person, you know, just there, but not really there.

And then I'll remind myself, you know, is it really worth it? Do I want to do it again? Next week will come by, next social occasion.

Then you start with, you know, one drink. Last year, I decided enough is enough. You know, I stopped.

It's been nine months. I have not touched a drink. The intention is to not do a drink.

And I agree with you on all the research I've seen. This alcohol, you know, I think has been marketed all too well, especially wine is good for you kind of marketing last 20 years. Absolutely bogus.

There's no truth to it whatsoever. Alcohol, I mean, I guess I can say on this podcast, at this point, I believe alcohol is as bad as smoking. It's only a matter of time before, I think science has already caught up.

There is absolutely no dispute as far as science goes. But the mainstream media and the communication has not caught up. I think it's a matter of time.

[Speaker 1] (23:26 - 24:17)

But there's one point there. So the thing is, apparently most people die of loneliness and stress. I

mean, that's really the bigger killer than, you know, cardio or mental and etc.

I mean, loneliness and stress. And then if a little bit of alcohol can get you over that. Now, the question is, is it is it a safe enough compromise to make or not?

Because, you know, if a drink is a reason for you to get together with friends, can it bring down the stress in a way helping you in some way? It doesn't. I mean, there is that school of thought as well.

I mean, but you need to be conscious of the fact that it's not good for you physically in any way. But can it somehow, you know, help you bring down your stress or help you get over any loneliness?

[Speaker 3] (24:17 - 24:37)

And maybe the key is to keep it to, you know, just one drink. The problem is the inhibition goes down so much after the first drink. And that's when your troubles start.

I mean, it's just I think much easier to not drink than to have just one drink and stop. Right. So that's like once the one becomes two or three.

And that's when, you know, I think you're well past solving for loneliness and social isolation.

[Speaker 2] (24:38 - 24:47)

Anna has never had a drink, no? Then you're the chauffeur when you don't drink, you know, with friends, you're driving them around. I've never.

I never did.

[Speaker 1] (24:47 - 24:51)

But what was the thing in your head which made you not even want to have a sip?

[Speaker 2] (24:52 - 24:58)

I guess, like I said, my martial arts background and then heavy drinkers at times in the family and what they go through.

[Speaker 1] (24:59 - 25:01)

Is that it? Like somebody you saw drinking heavily?

[Speaker 2] (25:01 - 25:45)

Not necessarily impacted. That hasn't impacted or, you know, that's not the decision. But then I've

seen people and behaviors change and people change and running a restaurant myself, a bar myself.

You know, we used to work with dad and took care of the bar. And I used to see mild, timid guys change with one drink, with two drinks, with three drinks and the fourth drink and different personalities. So I think somewhere down the line, I also saw too much of that and decided, you know what, it's better to stay away.

And then it became a challenge. And then people started, like I said, started appreciating your health. Then your career was dependent on your fitness.

[Speaker 1] (25:46 - 26:41)

See, I think last one week, right, like I saw so much content on fitness online. The one thing I realized is everybody has an opinion and generally it's a different opinion. So the intent of doing this today, in a way, was let's have one concise hour where each of you guys, through all the experience, you've written a book, which I'm going to read, but I saw bits of it.

It looks brilliant. And sorry about pulling your leg earlier. I will make it up to you before the end of it.

So maybe what we can do is go in a sequence. We'll stop from top priority, one each. And then we'll go to the second.

And then at the end of it, we'll try and arrive at a consensus. We'll make a list of 8 to 10 things that anybody can do with access to nothing. But following it for one hour a day and fitting those 10 things in will help everybody.

[Speaker 3] (26:42 - 26:54)

Before you go there, I just want to go back to what we were discussing. I'm also going to order some food. So I just need to know vegetarian, non-vegetarian.

Vegetarian, don't eat after 3 p.m. So I'm good. My God. Anna?

[Speaker 2] (26:55 - 26:58)

A mixture. Vegetarian, non-vegetarian. Like just appetizers, no carbs.

[Speaker 1] (26:59 - 27:02)

Dimsums and sushi kind of thing. You like dimsums? Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (27:05 - 28:48)

You know, this thing about fitness, drinking, sleeping, I observed a pattern a while back. My work,

kind of last 15 years, a lot of travel. There was a time when there was a lot of drinking.

Lack of sleep and fitness. Eventually I arrived at what I call a formula for a guaranteed way to fall sick. The formula is to go out for dinner, have a few drinks, sleep late, get up early, go to the gym, just crank it out, run hard 5 miles or do bodyweight and then take a flight.

Guaranteed in 24 hours you'll be sick. After 10 years of doing that, I realized every time that happens I fall sick. Because your immunity just goes for a toss.

You're not getting your body any time to recover. To be able to do all these things are putting a lot of stress on the body. Whether lack of sleep, fitness also puts a lot of stress on the body.

You just need time to recover. So I think these things in combination can be terrible, especially if they become part of lifestyle. So maybe coming back to your prompt, I think for me number one thing is sleep.

If I have to do only one thing for general health, I'll optimize 7-8 hours sleep. I think for me that takes the cake. I personally sleep very early.

I go to bed by 9 and get up around 5 or so. But I think it doesn't matter. As long as you optimize for that 7-8 hours, it does wonders to everything else.

You can have incredible next 16 hours where you can push yourself to the hilt, whether it's work or workout or whatever your calling is. This I've arrived at after a long period of time. I've done all kinds of things, good and bad, to experiment with myself.

But now I feel both from personal experience, from everything I understand about science of sleep, for me it is at the top of the list.

[Speaker 2] (28:49 - 29:18)

Anna? For me I think it's consistency. I have to do it consistently.

I have to put in 5-6 days in a week where I do it. It might vary depending on the kind of work that I'm doing. How much and consistency with focus.

And focus, when I talk about fitness and health, it's about, I don't care about equipment, I don't care about anything. I care about what muscle am I training, how much time am I going to give for it to recover.

[Speaker 1] (29:19 - 29:22)

So would you say consistency in working out every day? Working out every day.

[Speaker 2] (29:22 - 30:23)

Do you work out 7 days a week? 6 days a week, following a routine. If I miss a day during the week, I will not cheat on my Sunday.

For me Sunday means give everything up, don't do anything. I'm probably the laziest, I won't even pick up a glass. I'd expect my children, my wife to feed me and do everything.

That's how lazy I am on a Sunday but it works brilliantly because it helps me recoup. For each individual it's different. What works for me might not work for you.

That's why you go on the net and suddenly you have 5 million people giving you Gyaan at the age of 20. It's very easy to do that. But I'd like to see that journey till the end of the day.

Till nobody is supporting you when you need it most. You should need support. Why 70 or 60 a number where they say senior citizen.

What do you mean by that when it comes to health? That's why consistency. Absolutely.

[Speaker 1] (30:26 - 31:49)

Top of the list. I think it's food for sure. Even for sleep, what I've realised is my sleep quality is based on what I'm consuming.

So if I had to really put something right on top, it's food. But what I've realised is my food choices are based on my workout choices. If I've not done workout first thing in the morning, I tend to end up picking up bad food.

Which in turn ends up messing up my sleep. So it's kind of interconnected. But if I had to put right on top it would be food.

But unfortunately I'm not disciplined enough to constantly keep making the right food choices. Unless I have a hack in terms of getting a workout first thing in the morning. Even if you're not making the choice, if your endeavour is to put that on top, you can say it.

So it's food. I think for me it's sleep. I struggle to fall asleep and I start work early in the morning.

So I have to work out at night. I typically go to the gym at 10pm or 11pm. Which in turn is a cycle which will make it harder for me to sleep the next night.

And I think I've not been sleeping enough for a long long time. And if I could figure out a way to get 8 hours of deep sleep, REM sleep, all of that. I would put that number 1 on my list.

Next, number 2.

[Speaker 3] (31:49 - 32:01)

I think since you are the youngest among all of us, I think you can probably get away with that. In your 30s, maybe in your 40s. At some point I think it starts to catch up.

So that's probably you can think through. I think you have plenty of time on your side fortunately.

[Speaker 1] (32:02 - 33:28)

Yeah but I'm trying. It just doesn't fit into my entire schedule. If I have to work out in the evening, I prefer to go to the gym when there's nobody in the gym.

And if I end up going at 6pm, there will be people. But I have to go beyond 8.30pm, 9pm. There's a bunch of tweaks which I have to do which I don't know if the pros weigh the guns.

I mean the crazy bit is, you know, like he trades the market, right? There is this whole news around stock markets being extended till 11.30. You know, if that were to happen, you know, guess what's going to happen to you Steve? You know, since the day I started trading, I'm talking like 17-18 years.

I think I was sick once. Sick enough not to trade. And I was in the hospital for 10 days or something.

I'm talking, what was that? 12-13 years ago? Something like that.

12-13 years ago I had a liver problem. I was in the hospital for a fortnight maybe. But outside of that I've not missed a single day trading.

So I've not had a single day off in pretty much 18 years outside of that. So it's more than a job for me. It is also an addiction.

It's also a way of life where my life is dictated less by my timings but more by the timings of financial events happening in stock markets.

[Speaker 3] (33:29 - 33:44)

Yeah, and I think, you know, having that deep passion for something is equally or even more important, right? You know, we all need good health so that we can pursue our dreams, our passion, right? So that's very, very important.

Health ultimately has to service some end.

[Speaker 1] (33:45 - 33:54)

I think that line between passion and addiction is very thin. I'm flirting with either side. I need to come to terms with which side I'm flirting with.

[Speaker 3] (33:55 - 34:53)

But we can move on. Number 2. Number 2 for me is, I would just say, general movement.

And movement throughout the day. You know, we don't need to sit, you know. I mean, I work out in the morning but I think the last few years I've adopted this habit and started in the pandemic.

I just stand in the meeting. So in the conference room there are 10 of us and I'll be sitting in that corner. And while I'm sitting, you know, I don't think the camera can demonstrate but, you know, I will stretch my leg, I'll do this, I'll do this, you know.

I call it an all-day movement. For me, and even people who don't work out, there are plenty of opportunities, you know. Just go out for a small stroll in the sun, stand for some time.

During the pandemic, I had this treadmill with the iPad on top and I'm walking on the treadmill and doing Zoom calls with the people. And before you know it, you're getting 15-20,000 steps. So any kind of movement.

I think our bodies are designed to move. Just being, you know, sedentary, especially in an office job, sitting on a chair all day. I think it's terrible.

I mean, the body is not designed for that kind of function.

[Speaker 1] (34:53 - 35:45)

Can I ask you another question? Like, the two of us are largely one-trick ponies. I have been trading all my life.

He's been in the finance side business all his life. We've been doing similar things. You've had a much more eclectic, esoteric life in a way.

You did e-commerce and then suddenly switched to health. And then before that you were in the US trying to build a startup. I think that is incredibly more impressive because if you were to tell me today, do something else which is new altogether, it would scare me.

And I'm guessing it would scare you too. What were the trigger points which made you move from The Valley to Myntra, which was again a really large company, to the whole fitness journey and now the food and everything else?

[Speaker 3] (35:45 - 37:33)

I'm glad you see it that way. I think everything has two sides. I definitely will not call you guys one-trick pony.

I think your own business has evolved dramatically. And I have some ringside view as I invested

and grown. I've seen this industry evolve last few years.

So I think your own business and the product has evolved. I think almost in every business goes through reinvention. And I think you want to build a cathedral.

It takes 20, 30, 40 years. So I have way more respect for that versus doing something every five to seven years. My journey ended up being that because of variety, all of it is not planned.

It's not like I had a game plan in mind and I started and planned out that way. I mean, things happen. I think I had a healthy risk appetite.

I mean, so did you guys, I guess, early on. At some point, when I started to feel very comfortable, I started to get jittery. I think call it looking for an adventure or wanting to learn something new.

And I started to almost, fortunately, it's not as bad as looking for next shiny thing. But I get a huge kick out of trying to do something new from scratch. But I've been a startup guy all my life.

I worked for four startups in Silicon Valley. Then I was part of Mintra Journey, CureFit Journey. I worked closely with the two startups the last five years.

First Grow and Skyroot, which are building rockets. There was a first successful launch last year. So kind of understand startup world.

And I think I keep feeling that tug. And I'm now thinking, how can I do more of that? What are the other companies that I can build or co-build with somebody else?

And what could be a method to still do it systematically where you build a strong foundation? You design it for the long term. But what is the right method to that?

I'm exploring, hopefully, in a few months or end of this year. I'll have better clarity on that.

[Speaker 2] (37:34 - 37:40)

Anna? I think for me, after consistency is probably food. Food plays a very, very important role.

[Speaker 1] (37:40 - 37:45)

Can you just tell us your diet? Because this is a mystery we all need to solve together.

[Speaker 2] (37:45 - 37:58)

For me, it's the quantifying of the food. Normally for me at home, it's a four egg, egg white because I don't like the yellow.

[Speaker 1] (37:58 - 38:02)

Do you care for things like allergy tests and not eat what you're allergic to?

[Speaker 2] (38:02 - 41:40)

Of course I do. Because, like Mughesh said, how he realized what works for him doesn't work for me. My gut was an issue in the sense I used to get headaches.

By the end of the evening, I realized I used to get light headaches. And that was because of the gut issue. And I realized that the gut was the cause of all the problems there was.

There was something that wasn't suiting me. And over a period of time, I learned as things improved here and we started getting better allergy tests and more precise and accurate, I realized that gluten is something that never worked for me. Probably because I came from a background that spoke about rice more than wheat.

And I had to go back to my roots. And that brought about a big change. Dairy doesn't suit me too much.

More so when you talk about the casein and other things in the product. Like gluten, dairy products were a problem because lactose was the problem. So when I switched to lactose-free milk, it worked for me in small quantities.

So for me, food is probably three or four eggs in the morning. Typical gluten-free toast or bread that I have. Again, it's quantified.

I quantify my food. I make sure what my activity for the week is. And then accordingly, play with the quantity.

And how much protein do you take as a factor to your weight? See, I go into the gram factor right now. It could be probably four eggs in the morning.

Maybe 150 to 200 grams depending on fish or chicken that I eat. And another 150 to 200 grams in the evening. Back into the right kind of fats.

And even if I talk about grams in greens, it's probably 200 and 200. So you're looking at 1,600, 1,700 calories. Or going up to 1,900 when I need to load it with carbs.

So I load it more with rice because rice suits me very well. Then for me, the quantity of salt that goes into it. Or the quantity of sugar that I consume through the day.

Do you consume sugar at all? Yes, I do because I don't believe in anything else. I don't believe in the substitute for sugar.

For me, it's either my fruit or my sugar. I like a cup of tea because it gives me the right, you know, it makes me feel good. One cup in the morning and one cup in the evening.

But once again, it's probably five to six grams of sugar. It's like no sugar at all but still gets me going. And what I like to do, I continue to do because it works for me.

Quantity of salt, it's never salt in the food. I'd rather have it sprinkled on top. You know, no pink salt for me, regular salt for me is what suits me.

So this is how I break it up. And I work with a nutritionist. I work with him because I want to understand it better.

That's not something I have mastered it. But being able to keep weight in check, being able to keep the inch in check, to be able to keep the muscle in check is why I sit and consult and discuss with them week on week, you know. And if there is a particular craving, then I ask for that, you know.

I love my fruit. I love my dessert. And if you tell me no dessert after food, I'd go crazy.

But then I've learned my blend of lactose free yogurt.

[Speaker 1] (41:40 - 41:42)

But your portions are really small, I'm guessing.

[Speaker 2] (41:42 - 42:54)

Yeah, my portions are controlled. I'd have fruit of the season mixed with yogurt and created in such a way that when frozen, it tastes like frozen yogurt or ice cream and my job is done. So my craving doesn't come in.

And then generally 7 o'clock, I finish dinner and make sure my gut is right. Because then I need, like he says, you know, he needs to walk after he's eaten or he's had a drink. I feel I need to be active after dinner.

Could be for half an hour, but I'd walk around. I'd stand, like Mukesh says, I'll always walk up the stairs. I try and avoid the lift when it comes to work.

On the set, I'm walking. You'll rarely see me sit, you know, and it's helped me. I don't know how much it's helping me, but to date, it's helped me a hell of a lot.

It's helped me stay fit. And, you know, my off and on pranayamas, even if it's thrice a week or four times a week, even if it's in the evening, I do my half an hour breathing that keeps me light in the head.

[Speaker 1] (42:54 - 43:07)

So it's gym plus pranayama three, four times a week. Can I ask you another question? Your idea

to send, your idea to nudge the kids to be actors?

No, not at all.

[Speaker 2] (43:08 - 44:35)

Their decision. As a matter of fact, we'd gone to Atlanta to Emory for Thea, and she saw the college, everything done, loved it, got admission. On our way back, she tells me at the airport, you know, Baba, I'm not really happy doing this.

I said, what do you want to do? She says, I want to be in the business of films and entertainment. And I said, are you sure about it?

And she says, yes. I said, you know what? It's a lovely place.

But, baby, will you be able to accept failure is something that you need to be ready about because that's very stressful. That Friday kills me every time. If I have a bad gut, it's that Friday that gives me the bad gut, not my food.

It's the anxiety that kills me and nothing else because the world is judging me. I've worked a year to create something with a team, and somebody sits there in the first ten minutes and says, you know, bullshit. And that's what goes viral, and that's what works because that's what people would like to spread.

So that's the only thing I tell the kids. If you're ready to take failure, you don't look at it as failure. You look at it as a learning.

You say, you know what? I tried something. I failed.

Take it up. Because if you fail, nobody will let you go. The media will pounce on you.

People will pounce on you because the world is looking at you. You know, you fail in business. You try something else.

You try something else. But not here. So that's the only thing.

[Speaker 1] (44:35 - 45:17)

I think that's the thing I was alleviating to earlier. Like in business, in a job, we guys kind of like have some kind of a say in the result. Like here there's no science.

The reason why something works and something does not, nobody knows. And unlike a company being judged, I think an individual being judged is a lot more personal. And I think people have made a habit through anonymity of being nasty for no reason.

I think nine out of ten times given a choice, people like to say mean things. Right. For some

psychological benefit.

[Speaker 2] (45:18 - 46:40)

And it's tough. It's tough when you're walking with family and somebody says, Yeah, it's Sunil Shetty. Oh, his last film was a flop.

It hurts. You know, it takes a hell of a lot to be that actor and say no. You know what?

I love this profession and I want to be there. And it impacts everybody. It impacts the children.

I made sure that I didn't send my kids to an Indian Indian school. But it was headed by an American board and it had faculty that was American. It's because I didn't want anybody to treat them either specially, either special, a celebrity kid or pan them for whose children they are.

I said, you know, let them go into a world that doesn't care who they are. And somewhere down the line, I feel that worked for me. It was a decision I took years ago.

And I still remember that saying that's a lot of money. And but I said that you're the one who always said that Buddhist Shastra is the only thing that survives. So it's a call that you have to take.

I have to work hard for it. I know. But I think I'll manage.

You know, I'll have children who will be far more respectful when it comes to the world then other than that. And, you know, I've realized that everybody says, film me kids, film me kids. But I think they are more conscious.

[Speaker 1] (46:40 - 47:47)

The little bit that I know your kids, they are some of the most well-behaved people I've met. I should not even be calling them kids. But they are some of the most well-behaved people I know.

No, but I think Bollywood is, I think the biggest challenge being an actor, in my, you know, like as an extension to what you just spoke, is actually being constantly being judged. I think that's because otherwise a movie, an actor being successful is very similar to a business. There is no science about building a business.

The differentiation is once you've built a business and you've been successful once, you don't start all over again. Yes. As an actor, you start all over again.

People only remember your last film. Constantly being judged is a problem. Like, you know, so I'm sure all of us, you know, when we go to the small little startup events, right?

We are rock stars there. But it gets annoying in like 15 minutes, right? And I constantly, every

time I think about it, I think like, how do Bollywood stars manage it?

Because, you know, you are exposed to that 20…

[Speaker 2] (47:47 - 48:00)

You are supposed to manage it. You have to manage it. You know, when you are on flight and suddenly you see a picture somewhere and…

Was my mouth open when I was sleeping? Who took this picture? Who took this picture?

[Speaker 4] (48:00 - 48:01)

That's the question.

[Speaker 2] (48:01 - 48:59)

They've done it. You know, you've had people… You are sleeping on flight and you are suddenly taking a selfie and you are fast asleep.

What do you do? What do you do? I mean, that's the price you have to pay.

You know, that's why a lot of times when people tell me, I love traveling within the country because I actually believe I enjoy myself the most. But the only thing sometimes you think twice is, yaar abhi yaar yeh Bulboy bhi aayega, abhi woh bhi aayega, phir waiter bhi aayega. Every 10 minutes they expect you to…

Sir, ek hi toh picture hai. Dekin din mein jab hazaar ho jaate hain na, it's tiring. It's tiring.

You need to be very, very, very, very patient. That's the only thing I've always told the kids ki, if you can handle that, best profession to be. Where do you get so much love here?

You know, your face, your heart, it's a passport that opens any door. You know, privileges are also there.

[Speaker 1] (48:59 - 51:45)

Especially in a country like India where almost 150 crore Indians are following Bollywood. So, I am trying to change my life in such a manner where now I am waking up in the morning and sitting in the sun and reading a book for half an hour because this is a novelty to me. I don't know what getting light into your eyes every morning does for your circadian rhythm.

I still don't get it. But I am trying it. I don't know if it works yet.

But if you guys have tried it for longer… I mean, I have experimented with every single thing. So, I want things like that.

Get light in the morning for 20 minutes. Eat this food to increase testosterone. Sleep for 8 hours.

I want 10 things like that. Got it. So, my first was get workout first thing in the morning.

Food. And third thing is I think health can't be looked at as 80-90 minute allocation per day. I think it's a 24-7.

But what I am saying is my third thing would be what Mukesh said earlier. Constantly move through the day. I have set on my watch a timer for every hour.

It buzzes so I get up and I do something. Do you still need to do that if you are working out for one hour a day? Yeah.

I think you absolutely should. Because, you know, I had really bad shoulder problem. When COVID first hit, right, and sitting, I mean, you were having this problem, right?

Because you are constantly looking at the monitor. You are just typing. And I have this habit of kind of leaning towards my left.

My entire left shoulder. And then the only fix I did was that. Every one hour get up.

Otherwise, you know, you will be in this posture for 2-3 hours. You will not even feel the stress you are putting on your body. I do that.

My back is screwed. So, every month I go to a chiropractor. But I have like cupping, needling, physiotherapy, all of that.

Because by virtue of sitting like this pretty much all my life, the doctor says this part of my neck is extended and this part is contracted. So, what do they call those exercises where you activate this? I can't remember the word.

But I need to go to the gym and do this. And then move my hand back, laying down, stuff like that. But, you know, that is a very hard thing to do.

Like the chiropractor will tell me, get up every one hour and take a break. But if you are doing something and you are engrossed. But today you have, you know, you have technology to leverage on, right?

You can set a, you know, like there are apps today where you can set an alarm to buzz every one hour. I mean, no, it becomes, I think, for me it becomes second nature. I think it takes a while to get used to it.

So, you get up every one hour and then stretch. Just stretch. Just walk around.

Like do something. Especially, I mean, I don't think it's a big problem in Bollywood. Because I

don't know if you are getting to sit for long hours, right?

I mean, you are probably always active.

[Speaker 2] (51:45 - 51:46)

Yeah, always, always active.

[Speaker 1] (51:46 - 51:48)

I think it's more a corporate world problem, right?

[Speaker 2] (51:48 - 51:49)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (51:51 - 54:41)

And so, I think it's important to do that. Because otherwise what happens is one, you know, you are always one injury away from everything else going bad. Like, you know, like a shoulder pain means I probably may not work out the next day.

You know, because I am in pain. Right? So, yeah, I think constantly keep doing something and constantly moving.

I think the best thing I have done in my life is wearing an activity tracker. You know, I have set, I mean, activity tracking goal for the day. So, which means at the end of the day I should have moved this much.

Right? And yeah, so I try to do that consistently. And I think from the time I started doing it, it's helping me quite a bit.

Okay, my next thing is what does one do about testosterone? I think this is a modern day man problem where testosterone levels are low, cortisol is high. And because of that it becomes significantly harder to put on muscle.

And also sleep. So, just as a thought, in my research online, people are talking about things like L-Arginine, that Ali, that Taunkat Ali. What is that?

Taunkat Ali. Stuff like that. These are not jabbing testosterone into your body.

But these are natural herbs which could increase the odds of your body throwing out testosterone or developing testosterone. What do you think about supplements like this? Do you think this is such a big problem that most people need to supplement for this?

Also, like, none of us are doctors. This is not medical advice. Like full disclosure, like always, go

consult your doctor.

But what do you think of testosterone as a problem? And what are the solutions you guys have tried, what has worked, what has not? So, what you spoke about are adaptogens, right?

So, Ashwagandha, Ginseng, Taunkat Ali, Fudoshia Agrestis. Have you tried them? Yeah, I've experimented with every single one of them.

And has the number gone up? No, it hasn't. No?

Not at all? No. So, we both, funny story, but we both went to a doctor and did like a full body checkup.

And like small kids, we put both our reports next to each other and we compared each metric. So, we were both quite bad, but I was significantly worse, even though I'm younger and all that. My testosterone is lower, my cortisol is higher.

So, these people talk about it like this stuff really works. No, it doesn't. I think it's very, I think it works.

Like every human's different. See, the thing about this adaptogen is like it reacts differently with everyone. To every individual.

[Speaker 2] (54:41 - 54:47)

It's like supplements. Yeah, it is. Supplements, you might be able to absorb it and somebody else might not be able to absorb it.

[Speaker 1] (54:47 - 55:25)

No, like if I have a coffee in the evening, I cannot sleep at night. Like my wife, she can do espresso shots and sleep in like 10 minutes, right? As in, how is it even possible?

As in, so, it's, yeah, so it's, but I've experimented just to, and then I've seen my test scores to see if it's kind of helped. What all did you try and how much did you try? I mean, like 2-3 months, you know, like cycles.

So, Tongat Ali for 2-3 months, let's say 500 mg a day. I mean, I can't remember. Ashwagandha for 2-3 months.

Yeah, Ashwagandha I've tried. I mean, in cycles, you know, in different times. And nothing changed?

So, the thing is, once my sleep improved.

[Speaker 2] (55:26 - 55:26)

Everything improved.

[Speaker 1] (55:26 - 55:49)

You know, the scores went up. Now, do I give credit to one of these things or do I? How much are you sleeping now?

I'm getting 7-8 hours sleep. Every day? I mean, there are days, of course, you know, when you miss it.

But on 90% of the days, I get 7-8 hours sleep. Anna, do you have fish oil? I do.

Everybody talks about fish oil like it's a no-brainer. Why is that? Would you like to answer?

[Speaker 3] (55:53 - 55:57)

I think you should answer. I'm not recalling exactly. I think anyone, whoever wants to.

[Speaker 2] (55:57 - 56:25)

I mean, everybody says overall health, overall health and overall health and it works. And that's why you do it, you know. But for me, see, I also take the breaks because I don't take anything.

But it's like magnesium helps you sleep. So, you know, you take it because it helps there. And whether it's fish oil or calcium and bones and movements and that's what you read and that's what you follow.

But I think fish oil we can all say is okay.

[Speaker 3] (56:26 - 56:48)

Yeah, I think it's something that everybody should take. Especially for vegetarians, I think there are all these, you know, different fatty acids. I think fish oil is supposed to have DHA and EPA.

If I'm getting it right. And for vegetarian people, there is no other source of getting those essential fatty acids. So, there's one source.

But exactly what it does, you know, I'm not sure. I've been taking it. One of those things that, you know, you come across, you experiment, you sort of feel good.

[Speaker 1] (56:48 - 56:49)

Because part of you likes that.

[Speaker 3] (56:49 - 56:50)

But this is one thing that we all four are doing.

[Speaker 1] (56:51 - 57:06)

Right, fish oil. Yeah. And it seems to be working.

I think if you look at supplements, I think the way I think of it is every time someone suggests, my research is more like, can it do any harm if you do it? If it doesn't do any harm, I'm like, okay, it's a check mark, let's do it.

[Speaker 3] (57:07 - 58:09)

I think any discount supplements, and I think Sunil you mentioned earlier, I think one has to continuously measure yourself. Taking supplements and not measuring, you know, and it's quite involved, you know, expensive. You know, you have to, but there are hundreds of blood markers and many other tests.

Because you put something in your body and you don't know what it is affecting, how it is affecting, for better or worse. That is one consideration. Second is, you know, at some point you can so depend on that.

See, all the things we have, you know, body has the ability to control cortisol and the ability to produce testosterone. So, if you are managing with supplements for how long, I think one needs to also think about how do I manage that thing through natural means as well, so that at best it's just a crutch I'm using for some time to fix something and not something I'm adopting for the rest of my life. Unless it's something absolutely harmless.

You know, this is not going to cause any harm. It's a kind of insurance policy. A lot of multivitamin is that insurance policy.

But I think it's not something that we can advise that take this supplement, everything will be fine for you.

[Speaker 1] (58:09 - 58:36)

I mean, not take this supplement, but more like what are we taking? No, but supplement as the word says is a supplement. It cannot replace anything.

I mean, you still have to get a balanced diet. Yeah, but that's how I think of supplements. So, if I'm having, so if I were to say my routine of supplements, yeah, there are multivitamins, there is omega, there is whey.

I mean, I love, you know, after every workout, I look forward to my whey protein. Do you have whey?

[Speaker 2] (58:37 - 59:03)

No, I did try it for a bit, but it doesn't work for me. There's a lot of bloating, probably because of my lactose issues. And even though they say there's none, you know, it doesn't work for me.

So, I try to supplement it with my food and no other way. And it works for me because the quality of muscle is maintained, you know, but yeah.

[Speaker 1] (59:03 - 59:51)

I think one of the things about quality of muscle, right, what I've realized is the younger you start, like, you know, this whole trying to get muscle on your body once you're in your 30s and 40s is so much more harder. Haven't we been trying for like 20 years each? No, I mean consistently.

You know, the other day I met the doctor and he said… The endocrinologist? No, no, another doctor.

So, I had gone to a sports doctor from joints and etc. So, he asked me how long you've been working out. I said for 20 plus years, but consistently over the last 2-3 years.

So, he said, no, no, forget the 20 years. Tell me consistently. All that matters is that 2 years of consistent work.

Because, you know, as kids, I think, you know, when you work out, you put on muscle that stays on you for longer.

[Speaker 2] (59:51 - 1:01:40)

Even when you grow old. Muscle memory, you know, and that's the advantage probably I've had as to going forward the next generation might not have, might have is the freehand stuff that we did. Because the equipment was not there.

There were basic numbers. I grew up on a pull-up bar. What age did you start working?

Oh, I started martial arts when I was 12 and 13. And, you know, I wanted to play cricket and I wanted to get stronger. I met Vivian Richards and he says, you know, you need to do weights.

But I was very conscious of the fact that they said overhead weights means you won't grow. Gymnastics means you won't grow. You know, and that stayed with me.

And so, I took up, they said, I took up the body weight. So, I did a lot of pull-ups. And everything for me was the monkey bar.

Everything for me was the monkey bar in school. And even when I started hitting the gym, which is a very small gym, probably 200 square feet, and I had one little machine there, but I had a

beautiful pull-up bar. I still remember doing 200 to 300 pull-ups every session.

That's crazy. You know, so I'd do something that I'd want. For me, rest was.

How many sets? It could be 50 sets, 100 sets. That didn't matter.

I just counted the number of pull-ups because it looked good, felt good. I can do maybe like 10 each for 3 sets. Yeah, but that is damn good.

I mean, today, kids don't do that. But calisthenics and all other formats have come where, you know, keeping the gym aside, getting into those physical activities will probably help build that muscle memory, you know. And that's why the Surya Namaskar will always be something that is magical when it comes to overall body and fitness.

[Speaker 1] (1:01:41 - 1:03:26)

So one of the things I've been listening on quite a bit is this Peter Attia, right? So he, you know, I think I started listening to him last year, and he spoke about the dead hang, you know, which is you hang on a bar. So how long can you do now?

I can do 2 minutes, 10 seconds, you know. So he says the ideal strength for you is if you can do dead hang for like 2 minutes. Like, you know, and he's got, you know, there are a few interesting concepts that are completely sold the way he says it.

One is around this whole, like a back-casting, as he calls it, which is, you know, think of how you want to live your life the last 10 years of your life. Like, you know, if you want to live between 80 to 90, what is the quality of life you want to live? And if you want to be able to say, you know, say I want to be able to trek when I'm 90 years old.

And if I want to be able to trek when I'm 90 years old, today I need to make lifestyle changes today, because strength and VO2 max keeps deteriorating every 10 years, right? So I need to ensure I'm able to, I'm at least at this amount of strength today, so that when I'm 80, 90 years old, even when the deterioration with age happens, I'm at a certain level to be able to do that activity, right? So, yeah, so I think, I think even for, you know, one of the things, the more I researched about dead hang, I realized that, so I also have a problem with my spine being a little curved.

So what happens is there's a muscle imbalance, you know, so every time I put on muscle, so because of this curved spine. Then when I was researching on dead hang, I realized that it's actually so good for your spine. You know, so it's, I should have ideally done this.

So you do it every day? No, every day is too much because you're, you know, you tire your forearms and your wrists. End of the workout?

Once in three days types. End of the workout?

[Speaker 3] (1:03:26 - 1:04:31)

Yeah. What about sauna and cold plunges and cryotherapy? I am personally a big fan for both.

I think both heat therapy and cold therapy of any kind. You were speaking to us the last time you came here and you were saying you have a cryo machine. I have a, yeah, this tub which keeps the water at about, you know, temperature preset.

I generally keep it around 10 degrees and once or twice a week, you know, I will do three, four set of one minute each. But that's, you know, yeah, that's cold therapy. Overall, I think both cold and heat, as I understand, work in a different manner.

But most of it boils down to, you know, this whole idea of controlled stress. And when you put your body into a managed controlled stress situation, then body reacts to that. Body reacts to cold in certain way, body reacts to, you know, heat in certain way.

And don't ask me about the actual mechanism, how and why it works. But generally helps tremendously with recovery and also boosts immunity. Assuming you are doing everything else also which are more fundamental in this.

But I have been doing, you know, cold treatment and heat.

[Speaker 2] (1:04:31 - 1:05:32)

No, it works, it works. Do you do sauna or cold plunge? Cold plunge, I don't do the cold plunge.

Of course, when I bathe, it's always cold water wherever I am. And it works brilliantly for me. Like he says, de-stressing, whether it's stress, whether it's, you know, body pain and injury and recovery, it works.

When you talk about heat, it's about the toxicity. You know, getting it out of your body, getting the toxins out and that's why it works. Because of the kind of food that we are consuming, one needs to.

And cold has always worked, you know, even if you talk about injury and the rush of blood and recovery, it always works. This does work and that's why they say you should always also sweat when you train. You know, whether you're in the gym or you're outside, sweating always helps.

Whether it's body odor, overall feeling.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:34 - 1:05:50)

So a lot of people are talking about the importance of good fat. And they're talking about all meat, less carb diet. Or all meat, some vegetables and less carb diet.

Have any of you guys tried it? You obviously not.

[Speaker 3] (1:05:51 - 1:05:53)

I actually have, so I have an interesting story to tell.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:53 - 1:05:54)

But you said you're vegetarian.

[Speaker 3] (1:05:54 - 1:07:38)

I am now vegetarian. I was also vegetarian when I grew up. But so in my 20s, you know, I got into this bodybuilding.

This was in 2000, you know, early 2000s. And at that time, the whole bodybuilding, you know, concept was eat every three hours and you need to have protein every meal. And as a vegetarian, you know, beyond a certain point, how much, you know, whey protein and casein also used to be quite popular at that time.

But even, you know, between my trainer and nutrition, we felt even that is not enough. So I forced myself to eat meat. I tried pretty much everything, you know, couldn't get used to it.

Like I just never could not. I tried for almost a year, literally forced myself to eat because I thought that, you know, I need to have so much protein, you know, for this much protein per body weight and so on. But at some point, you know, I just realized that's not for me.

I continue to take whey protein, etc. But over a period of time, I realized, I think general principles of food are very simple. I think we are made very complicated.

You need to consume all three macronutrients. I think fat was, you know, vilified for many decades. And I think that caused a lot of harm, you know, that enabled sugar to become a big part of people's life.

But these days, I think what the science says and what I also believe is as much as 20-25%, 30% of calories in your food can come from fat, almost any fat, you know, any combination of monounsaturated, polyunsaturated. So, if you are vegetarian, what is that fat? Ghee, coconut oil, olive oil, all kind of nuts, avocado.

Yeah. Plenty of choices. So, that, you know, healthy amount of protein for sure.

And by and large, complex carbs, you know, as long as… I think carbs, you need carbs also. I'm definitely not a proponent of going out of your way to avoid carbs.

You need to control it. Carbs should not be 80% of calories. It can easily be, you know, 30-40%

of calories and I think that's absolutely fine.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:38 - 1:08:07)

I think it's about staying, you want to stay lean, you want to bulk up, it's about muscle. Then the balance of carb might shift a little bit, you know, more than protein. But if you want to get leaner and you want to lose weight, then wear your protein intake.

But like Mukesh said, 20-25% fat is good enough. And it could be in the form of avocados or butter or ghee. For me also, it's ghee.

It's always ghee. We don't eat much carbs, right?

[Speaker 1] (1:08:07 - 1:09:10)

No, I mean, the thing is, I've come to a conclusion now that if anything slows me down, I'll do less of it. Like, you know, whatever I'm eating, you know, after eating, if I feel shit after a while, you know, so I do less of that. So, but I can't stay without carbs.

I mean, if I don't eat rice, I mean, oh God! I mean, like in two days without rice… It would be like one third of how much meat you're consuming.

Yeah, I mean, I'm not, I'm not that particular about sizes. I mean, I know portions now, but I try to stop eating before I feel full, which I've realized is a mistake. I mean, we both have done quite a bit in younger days, which is just keep stuffing yourself.

So, I think it's just… We ate like a lot of bad quality meat as kids. Yeah.

You know, bad quality. Not bad quality. Badly cooked.

Yeah. I mean, like… From bad places with toxic color and oil and stuff like that.

Like the kebabs, which look so red, you know, so…

[Speaker 3] (1:09:10 - 1:10:22)

In younger days, you can pretty much get away with it. Which you buy from the street side vendor and stuff like that. I think going back to your list, right?

I think one of the things we should definitely talk about and it'll be among my top four or five is just focus on some kind of meditation. And by that, I don't necessarily mean, you know, you have to use an app like, you know, Headspace or Calm. It's finding 10-15 minutes in a day just to center yourself.

For a lot of people earlier, you know, prayer used to be that time. So, that is one way to meditate. It could be just going outside and sitting in the sun, you know, maybe that's…

Just somewhere where you're just focusing on yourself. I think that, you know, I adopted meditation as a habit about 5-6 years ago. And I think it's one of those things in just 10-15 months of investment.

The return on that is just incredible. I think you feel a little more calm and centered. You're able to deal with stress.

Improves a bit. You're less agitated, you know, when the situation arises. So, I think that's probably one thing that most people even consider in some form.

There are so many varieties of meditation. One doesn't need to get too technical about it or just follow a particular style. But somewhere, you know, developing that awareness.

I had to find some time during the day. Preferably, as he says, consist to maintain consistency. Same time of the day, it could be, you know, on waking up or evening.

But I think, you know, that definitely makes a difference.

[Speaker 2] (1:10:22 - 1:11:35)

Health is not about just eating, about exercising or supplementation. It's about how you're feeling, how you're thinking and what you're saying. You know, when you say, I'm calm at work.

That calmness comes from that mental mindset. That's why for me, pranayama works like magic. You know, for me, that is meditation.

Or being able to focus on something. To be able to listen to what Mukesh is saying. Or listen to the questions you're telling me.

And being able to hold on to that. So that the good I can use somewhere else. You know, for me, that is focus.

And that is meditating. If I'm listening to a great script and I'm involved, the rest of the world doesn't matter to me. When worry doesn't come in, whether it's the health of my own health, family, business, disasters around me or my flops.

If I can listen to you and get excited, I think that is meditation for me. It's not about good food and not just about exercising. It's about that mental space.

[Speaker 1] (1:11:35 - 1:12:03)

I was about to say, not meditation, I was about to say hobby. You know, having a hobby that can keep you occupied. Because one of the things I've been doing, everyone at my house has an issue with it.

Which is, for around 20 to 30 minutes after my workout, I take my guitar and I sing. I sing loud. And I find it very meditative.

[Speaker 4] (1:12:06 - 1:12:17)

Kaisi hai paheli hai, kabhi toh aasaaye, kabhi yeh rulaye.

[Speaker 1] (1:12:19 - 1:12:41)

True, true. And my mom, you know, thinks I'm an amazing singer. She says I should record it.

But I do that and I play sports. So, I look forward to playing a sport over the weekend. So, it kind of, it falls in the same meditative bucket.

Yeah, yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:12:41 - 1:12:42)

Absolutely.

[Speaker 1] (1:12:43 - 1:14:13)

So, I have an 8 year old son now. So, one of the things I've done, which has helped me in my sleep, is to actually kill all my devices by like 1 or 2 hours before sleep. And some of these hobbies.

And hobbies also, you know, things that I keep changing. So, I find it intellectually challenging to pick up a new hobby. So, I start to learn the keyboard for a while.

So, yeah. So, I mean, I think all of this, it ends up sounding like it's very complicated to do, but it's not. I mean, I think it's, I think everyone should have a hobby.

Yeah, what about coffee, guys? Like, not will you drink coffee, but what do you think about drinking coffee? Would you want to drink a coffee?

No, I can't sleep after that. Anna, would you like a coffee? No.

I'm good. You guys don't say that much about health, but each time I offer you a fruit juice, coffee, it's like a blatant no. No, no.

I'm feeling, you know, like, because Sunil is around, you know, whatever I do will be like, you know. I think more than anything, right? Like, this is about four people coming together and hanging out.

Like, it does not even have to be about health. If you want to ask him about how big his biceps are, can you measure them with a tape, you can. No, no, but I think, I think, you know, now that

he triggered me, as in, when did the style change?

There's, you know, something about your style which changed, you know, like, from your younger days to now. I mean, now, you know, the kind of...

[Speaker 2] (1:14:13 - 1:16:30)

I feel more evolved. I think because fashion has changed so much, the availability of everything, the awareness of everything. You read, you watch, you see.

And then mentally, you know, when I took that break from cinema because crap was coming to me, and then dad fell unwell, and those three, four years with him where nothing in the world mattered. You know, I'd stop listening to everything around me. And when you start doing that, you realize what your strengths are.

You know, and the biggest high for me was, I spent the four most beautiful years of my life with my father, when probably he needed me most, you know, and that was my high. So for me, it was, you know, a lot of kids today don't do that, but I managed to do that. So that was the strength for me.

And fortunately, unfortunately, everybody believed that I didn't want to work, so nothing came to me. But the morning he passed away, that night he passed, the morning I got a call for one of the biggest health shows, you know, fitness shows, and I said, this is calling, this is him saying, you know, get back. That journey I learned so much from the kids, you know, and then I said, let me be me.

You know, the day you're comfortable with yourself, is I think the day you realize that there's so much in you that works. And I said, you know, grey hair, white hair, black hair, doesn't matter, let's go grey. Because then you say I have hair, you know, when you compare it to the rest of the industry, everybody is leaving and everything, everybody is doing stuff, somewhere I've done something right.

Whether it's the food or whether it is, so let it be. And let me age gracefully, because I've passed my prime when it comes to cinema and action and movies. So let me get comfortable with my own skin.

So I got comfortable with my own skin and I say, I'll play my age. And then everybody saw only the good in you, you know, oh, oh, young kids coming and saying, you know, sir, respect and stuff like that. So that confidence, like I said, when you hear it, things start getting better.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:30 - 1:17:09)

So about Bollywood, right? I mean, I'm sure a lot of people will be curious about this question, right? As in, while you, your fitness journey is like, you know, you started at 12.

But, you know, when you see some of these transformations of actors, you know, going from fat to like six packs in three months, six months. While it probably inspires a new generation of people to take up health and fitness, right? I mean, every time an actor has come shown six pack, I think, you know, like, I'm sure a cult subscription goes up.

But aren't you then setting up people with the wrong expectation that, you know, you can somehow go from here to here in three months or six months, etc.

[Speaker 2] (1:17:09 - 1:18:09)

Each one has his own journey. But if I talk to my son, I say, that's not the way you want to do it. If you want to get leaner, there is food that can help you do it.

I said that I'll get my six packs when I'm 60. And I did manage that at that time. Probably not as defined as this, because I don't do anabolic steroids.

I don't take creatine. I don't take fat burners. But I'm still, I still wear a 29 and a 30 from a ready counter when it comes to Myntra and the jeans.

Whichever brand that there is. You don't even need to measure. You can send it to me and I'll wear it.

That for me is my achievement. So I'm very clear with Ahaan or with any of the kids that come to me asking for help. Food can do it.

Habits can do it. Sleep can do it. Being confident about yourself can do it.

You know, but I am who I am. But my attitude will depend on who you are.

[Speaker 1] (1:18:09 - 1:18:14)

But what do you think about the, I mean, it doesn't work for me.

[Speaker 2] (1:18:14 - 1:18:44)

But do you, like someone should voice this out though, right? I'm constantly doing that. I'm constantly doing that.

That fitness is not as expensive or as difficult as one seems. It's the consistency that one has to do it with. And you can achieve it.

Okay, you might not achieve it in two months, but you will achieve it in 12 weeks or you will do it over 16 weeks. There's so many apps that are doing it. And you're seeing the transformations.

[Speaker 3] (1:18:45 - 1:20:25)

I think that also, you know, I think brings up a very interesting point. In last four or five years, as I looked more and more into science of health and also just studied generally what the traditional point of view on health is, huge convergence. On one hand, you know, you have intermittent fasting, you have calorie restricted diet and all the evidence-based studies for that.

On the other hand, fasting is part of every religious tradition. There is not a single region in the world with some kind of fasting protocol. It could be once a week, once a month, one month in a year, whatever the format is, because people realize that.

Similarly, we talk about meditation is very popular. We have all these cool apps now. But Pranayama, Dhyan, you know, has been part of this Ayurvedic tradition for a long period of time.

You know, we talk about, you talked about getting sunlight in the morning, Surya Namaskar, you know, that has always been there, right? A lot of stretching protocols. We talk about gratitude practice now.

We had prayers, you know, since ancient time. So I think there's a lot of, you know, conversion on this modern tools, which is great that, you know, there are people are talking about it, people are talking about the scientific terms. But what makes it even more better is that there is so much, you know, even ancient validation that people have been through trial and error, through, you know, they've arrived at these things, they've followed through, these things survive for thousands of years and nothing survives for that long unless there is, you know, true merit.

There are just few fundamental principles. In fact, you know, in my book, and not to promote the book here, but I think the, I think most of health advice, you know, boils down to this phrase I've used. It is eat less, sleep more, always move.

In whichever format you can do these three things. 80-90% of your health will be taken care of.

[Speaker 1] (1:20:26 - 1:21:12)

But you've gotten a lot fitter than two years ago, I have to say. You have. Can I flex?

Why don't you take off your shirt and flex? But I wanted to talk about one more thing. Because you're here, I think we have to use the opportunity to talk about the business of fitness.

How many people in our country are into fitness? And then we're going to come back to this conversation and summarize because I really want tangible, fungible takeaways of what people can incorporate. So we'll just summarize all we spoke about once and things that we think people should do.

But maybe you can talk about the business.

[Speaker 3] (1:21:12 - 1:23:42)

See, I think the answer to that is not enough. You know, we have only five million people in the country who go to gym, who pay for any kind of gym membership out of a country of 1.4 billion people. It's a 0.4% penetration compared to about 20% in US, 15% in Europe. So very few people are going to any kind of gym. If you include people who go to park for morning walk, run, etc. The number goes to about 10-12 million, so about a crore or so.

It's just too small. I think we are very early in the culture of fitness. People are just waking up to the potential of fitness.

And also the so-called Western lifestyle and what people call sad diet, you know, standard American diet is catching up with people. And a combination of sedentary lifestyle, poor diet choices is catching up. And so people have become aware, the number is growing.

But I think, you know, I would love to see that day. And not only because as a, you know, somebody who's involved with cult, but in general, I think physical activity is so important. And it was, I think, part of our culture in many different ways.

Until say, probably 30-40 years ago, you know, we used to go for morning walks, evening walks. In every small town, you will see people after the meal, they'll go for evening walks, right? A lot of free yoga classes will happen, you know, every neighborhood.

All of that has stopped. And this more organized way of fitness has not really taken off in a big way. But hopefully that will change, you know, I think.

We need to also talk about the, you know, how fast the lifestyle diseases. Lifestyle diseases are diseases of lifestyle, you know, diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular diseases, mental health issues, everything is on the rise. While on the fitness gym was a 5 million, the number for all these diseases are in many tens of millions.

You know, you start with 50 million for diabetes, go up to as many as 150 million people who are diabetic or pre-diabetic, right? And all those diseases are, it's not, you know, you are genetically and you have to get those. It's because people are getting accustomed to poor lifestyle choices.

A lot of people just don't know what is the right thing to do. The awareness is very low. Bad habits get formed.

Sometimes bad habits are promoted within the household. We have seen, you know, all these high sugar, so-called, you know, the health drinks, you know, that, you know, parents, you know, give to their young kids and you get used to that, right? And only now people are realizing how much, how high the sugar content is.

Like that case which is going on. Yeah, recently, I mean, that's, you know, it's great that awareness is building up.

[Speaker 1] (1:23:43 - 1:23:43)

Yeah, absolutely.

[Speaker 3] (1:23:44 - 1:24:29)

I mean, growing up, we all thought they were health drinks, right? You know, Maggi, another example, right? You know, it was, you know, wheat Maggi.

Yeah, wheat Maggi, which is probably, I don't know, 1%, you know, wheat or something like that, right? I think the point is, you know, we have gone from a lifestyle of abundance. You know, a lot of fast food has come in, a lot of packaged food has come in, which was growing up, I don't remember, you know, having access to a lot of packaged food and everything was, you know, locally grown, homemade, fresh, which is, you know, very cool now.

But it wasn't accessible to everybody just, you know, a few decades ago. So, I think this gap between the tremendous rise in lifestyle diseases and not enough culture of, you know, active lifestyle is a problem for the country and I hope in coming decades that changes.

[Speaker 1] (1:24:30 - 1:25:38)

This is something that, you know, like... Rain Matter Health also is there, right? So, yeah, there's been like a passion project, you know, for the last 2-3 years.

So, run this thing called as Rain Matter Health, you know, so we've been partnering startups, working in the space, who's trying to make it easier for Indians to make healthier choices, right? So, I've thought about it quite a bit over the last 2-3 years and I've come to a conclusion that, I think the only way to get that 5 million number to go up is, I don't know if people will, I mean, you need to, people will go for fitness reasons, you know, I mean, I think it has to be sport reason. I think, you know, sport has to be promoted in this country, you know, outside just cricket, right?

As in, I think if you look at the US, I think one of the big reasons why so many people go to the gyms is because this college scholarships, you know, that, you know, having a sports background that helps you get into a good college is a good, you know, is a reason, right? So, I think something like that has to happen in India, as in, you know, there has to be like this culture of playing sports that starts very early. Because if you're playing a sport automatically, you'll do everything else, right?

[Speaker 2] (1:25:38 - 1:26:01)

As in, basically, what you're saying is bang on, you know, extracurricular activity has to go out. And it has to be a part of the curriculum. It has to be, you have to be graded for that and you have to get scores for that.

And those scores should make a difference and that's the only way it will make that difference.

[Speaker 1] (1:26:01 - 1:26:37)

You know, if you really truly want to make a difference in this country in terms of health, I think it's about getting more people to play sports. You know, some physical extracurricular activities. I mean, this is something that, you know, internally, we were talking at Zaroda saying that maybe we should announce that, you know, in our hiring, we'll have 10% quota for, you know, like, you know, because, you know, businesses, even if you're not, you know, it's very hard.

Some businesses, if they come forward and start making these kind of announcements, maybe people think more about, you know, sports. So, yeah. But what are your vices, by the way, Sunil?

I mean, like you said, you like dessert.

[Speaker 2] (1:26:37 - 1:26:47)

Any dessert, any Indian sweet would work like magic for me. But I still control it. I control it a hell of a lot.

But yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:26:47 - 1:26:55)

Like, you know, if you're having a, I don't know, like, kaju burfi, can you stop at one kaju burfi? I don't like kaju burfi.

[Speaker 2] (1:26:55 - 1:27:43)

But anything else, I won't stop at. I can't stop. I can't.

What's your most favorite Indian dessert? All the laddus. You talk about the darwar peda when you come to Bangalore.

That's a killer. Or Mysore pak or anything. I mean, I'm a mithai guy.

I love my mithai. How often do you have mithai? Not often.

You know, I only, and for me, like they say, I have to take a vow or a badha and say main nahi ghaunga and that's when it works. But then, if somebody comes with a pooja ka thali and there's that peda there, I'll go for it first. The excuse being ki, nahi yaar, iska hai, you know, pooja ka hai.

[Speaker 1] (1:27:43 - 1:28:01)

By the way, you know, I got your stance on, you know, non-nutritive sweeteners, which is stevia, monk sugars. What is your stance on it? As in, do you, are you okay?

Because, you know, if you're going to get… Didn't who just come out and say it's bad? WHO?

No, I mean, I think it was misrepresented, you know, so I don't…

[Speaker 2] (1:28:03 - 1:28:04)

Did WHO come out with it?

[Speaker 1] (1:28:04 - 1:28:51)

They came up with a report last week. But, you know, I think the result wasn't, I think the way media has covered the result isn't, you know… But why would they?

You think, again, it's like lobby lobby? No, I mean, it's not about sugar lobby. I'm saying, yeah, I mean, the media, the way it is portrayed, it seems like it is, oh, we're getting healthy snacks.

Yeah. To stay in line with what we're talking about. Yeah.

Because this is something that I've been researching quite a bit. Because I have a sweet tooth. And we've ended up investing in a few companies which are, you know, making, should I say healthier dessert?

I don't know if it sounds like an oxymoron, but yeah, you know, so, you know, like a lower calorie dessert to be, you know, more.

[Speaker 3] (1:28:53 - 1:29:44)

So, I think on this artificial sweetness, I think the jury is still out. I think some of the, you know, earlier version of artificial sweeteners are definitely out. I think some of them are even carcinogenic and so on.

Some of these more natural sweeteners like monk sugar and stevia, don't know. I think hopefully we'll figure that out in next, you know, I don't know, five to ten years. People are working on it.

You can find both kind of stuff online today. But my personal take on it, things like, you know, occasional fruit or even, you know, putting honey in something every now and then or having some dates and so on is, I think, absolutely fine. As long as it's every once in a while.

Everyday consumption of sugar, I think, is just very unnatural. I think evolutionarily we are just never used to having so much sugar and that's, you know, very much out of sync within how our biology works.

[Speaker 1] (1:29:44 - 1:29:51)

Say, health is so important today, right? Yeah. Like, if you want to be an entrepreneur, to work at

full capacity, you have to be healthy.

[Speaker 3] (1:29:51 - 1:29:51)

That's right.

[Speaker 1] (1:29:52 - 1:36:23)

So, we have to condense this information in a manner, which is easily consumable to anybody who wants to be healthy. But not necessarily spend a lot of money or time on it. And you guys have to figure out how to do it.

The first starting point is, why care about health and fitness? I mean, like I said, I think, interesting concept here. I think Sunil is the right hero for that story.

Is that, you know, I think it's important to age stronger. Because I've seen it with my dad as well. Hey, talk about what dad's getting on.

Growth hormone, testosterone. No, no, he's not getting on that yet. So, no, we took our dad, you know, to an endocrinologist.

And because he was losing a lot of muscle, you know, he was kind of losing, he was becoming very frail. He's not very old, he's just 70 to 73 and he had a heart attack. There's nothing illegal about testosterone or growth hormone.

No, he's still not started that. I think that's the question to, like, preface the conversation. To be asked at that age.

And this is not for a 40-year-old man or a 30-year-old man. Right, right. So, yeah, so, I mean, we took the dad to the endocrinologist.

I think some of the things that the endo has spoken about, you know, as you grow older, your hormonal imbalances in your body is, you know, like a lot of time we don't, you know, we don't care about it. Like speaking about testosterone is a taboo, right? But men, over time, as they grow older, their testosterone keeps dropping, which leads to lower muscle loss, leads to higher stress and etc.

So, yeah, so I think the endo started my dad on DHEA supplements. And he started him on thyroid supplements. Because the thyroid activity when it, you know, is not optimal, you also, you know, bloat easily.

You lose muscles, etc. So, yeah, so it'll be interesting, you know, like I've been telling my dad is that if these things, what the endo said is if these things work well, maybe we can, you know, try testosterone. Maybe we can try growth hormones, etc.

So, so the next one, two, three years, I think my dad will be like, you know, if he suddenly goes from being frail to doing pull-ups, you know. And he used to be fit. When he was younger, he used to work out and all of that.

Yeah, he used to look like, you know, he used to be like really strong, you know, I mean. But I think another really smart doctor that I know, he was telling me that once the way we've evolved, right? Like up until a hundred years ago, we only lived till we were 40.

Now we live till we are 72, 80, 85. Your body beyond procreation does not want to inherently thrive, like hormonally. Right.

And for women, it's easy because the markers are more evident. Because you go through that menopause and, you know, for a fact, hormonally, your body is changing. But for men, they often silently suffer because they don't realize what hormones are not being produced in their body.

So this doctor, in fact, was recommending as early as 40 beyond that procreation age, right? Typical procreation age. One needs to start watching hormonal changes, supplement, diet, change.

And it just helps you in the long run. Like, you know, like the endo, right? Like I take vitamin D3.

He says almost every Indian is deficient in vitamin D3. You know, it's like, and vitamin D3 is a hormone, which I didn't know about, you know, until he explained. It's actually a hormone in the body and not a, like a multivitamin.

Because a lot of time people think vitamin D3 is like a, so but, you know, just to go back to this conversation, you know, I think medical progress is going to make sure that our life expectancy is going to keep going up. And over the last 20 years, India's life expectancy has gone from like 60 to 70. And it'll probably, by the time the current generation of people are 70 years old, the life expectancy will probably have gone to 80, 90.

So the question then is, what is the quality of life you want to lead the last 20, 30, 40 years, right? And the kind of life you live today is what will determine the quality of life then. Do you want to increase your lifespan or you want to increase your health span, which is, you know, you want to live longer healthily.

And this is a conversation, I think, you know, which has to be more mainstream. And because today, this whole, I work 20 hours a day, I don't sleep, you know, get celebrated. It's a wrong kind of celebration.

You know, I mean. And most often people are working 20 hours a day, not because their productivity goes up proportionately. I think it's the insecurity of not wanting to look like they're not working 20 hours a day.

Does that make sense in a very weird way? I think overworking is missold. I think, you know, because as you grow older, you suddenly realize that, I mean, in 20s and 30s, you can get away with it.

Now, I realized as soon as I got in my 40s, like what worked, you know, like I can't do that now. I mean, I can't. I need to have your body's evolving and you need to make changes.

So I think if we had to pick up saying why should people care about health and fitness? I think the easiest way I have found to explain to people within our company has been that, dude, you guys are going to live. Assume that most of you guys will live till 90 years old.

You'll probably stop working at 60. You have 30 years of your life. 30 years of your life, which is like a retirement period.

Now, one is what is the quality of life you want? And second, what is the health cost of that 30 years? As in, if you don't have had a healthy lifestyle, all the saving that you had from now to 60 will probably not be enough for you to take from 60 to 90.

For majority of the people, right? As in, because, you know, people tend to understand when it comes to, you know, like as soon as it's money, right? People relate better, right?

As in, if you can explain to people that if you can take care of your health better now, means you can lead to a better money outcome. People tend to then, oh, is it? And things like that.

[Speaker 2] (1:36:24 - 1:37:13)

Wellness cheaper than illness. That's what you'll have to drive in. But see, whenever you do that, a combined effort of doing everything together and understanding your body is very, very important.

You know, the process of aging and for me to do action. I do action. I mean, I used to do action blindly even then.

But even now, I feel I don't do those many amount of rehearsals when I do it. I watch, I learn, I do everything very slow because I know my body is slowed down. But the adrenaline kicks in instantly when you hear the word take an action.

You know, I never believed in massages, but today I believe, you know, yeah, that for growth and to continue to grow, I need those little, little things.

[Speaker 1] (1:37:13 - 1:37:14)

That's something we didn't talk about.

[Speaker 2] (1:37:14 - 1:37:45)

Massages every week? Once in 15 days at least. Like deep tissue massages?

Yeah, yeah, absolutely. Because growth, recovery, knots, those are the things we never knew about. When I was training, I never knew what a knot was and why when you open it, what happens, you know.

And how diets mess you up when it comes to injury and we all believe that injury is because only because of training or because we've done something wrong, but it's also because of your gut here.

[Speaker 1] (1:37:45 - 1:38:19)

I think massage and also like mobility, like, you know, I realized that in my 40s, like just doing, like I do hot yoga at least once a week or at least once in fortnight. I've started learning this animal flow, which is like really nice for mobility as well. And just stretching, you know, like post-workout stretching for like 10-15 minutes.

It's like, it's I think massages and for mobility, you know, stretching and exercise.

[Speaker 2] (1:38:20 - 1:38:41)

Yoga and the asanas are the answer for India. For mobility, everything is a take off from there. So it's the world, yeah.

When you're growing, you don't believe because you don't build those kind of muscles, you're not attractive enough. You know, you feel that, but you've done right.

[Speaker 3] (1:38:41 - 1:42:30)

I think all the answers are there, not very complicated and definitely Indian culture. I think a lot of solutions are available. I think going back to what you were saying, Nitin, is what will it take for people to, especially in their younger years, to take health seriously?

It's not really top of mind. Sometimes people get into it because of aesthetic reasons. You want to look a certain way.

And that's probably the biggest trigger for people to consider in their 20s and 30s. But that's where, you know, most of the changes can happen. You know, beyond that, the long-term impact of that, you know, building a strong foundation in your 20s, 30s and keep nurturing that in your 40s, 50s.

I think it's also not only about increasing your health span from 60 to 90, but even, you know, people who are not proactive about their health, they start to see things start to happen in late 30s, 40s onwards. You know, you start to gain weight. You start to have pre-diabetic symptoms.

You know, somebody will put on a statin for cholesterol management. You know, you start taking something for managing diabetes and so on. And I think that, you know, you start to have blood pressure issues.

You start to feel a little foggy in the mind, you know, difficulty to deal with stress and so on. There are a lot of, you know, silent effects that start to accumulate. So, I think the key point is, you know, what will it take for, you know, country at large to wake up to the need and the long-term impact.

Like I said, it's very difficult to visualize what will happen to me, you know, 30, 40 years out. I think, you know, there is also this other culture of you live only once, right? You know, I'm going to sleep when I'm dead, you know.

All those kind of, you know, misinformation that is almost glamorized at times, you know, and a lot of people buy into that because that seems more appropriate, you know, when you are a certain age. So, I think changing the conversation is probably very hard. I think no one person alone can do it.

I think it's, you know, everything from individuals, people who are, you know, public personalities, to the government, to anyone who was able to influence, you know, talking more about health. I think I remember in, I think in Michelle Obama, right, she had this whole movement around just, I think, something move. I forgot, you know, what the phrase was, right?

But, you know, she made it a mission for eight years in White House to only talk about getting people to move, right? You know, that's one effort, you know, many such others. So, I think we'll have to, as a country, you know, rise up to taking it really seriously.

Otherwise, eventually, health costs will add up. We can easily end up with a lot of people, to your point, living very long, but all of them need to be on some kind of medical attention continuously, right? You know, massively increasing healthcare costs, any quality of life is not great.

And so, yeah, big, you know, large problem. Glad you guys are, you know, taking initiative to at least, you know, initiate a conversation on this. Right.

Yeah. Some of the biggest mistakes you realized you were making later? Yeah, so I was, you know, at some point, you know, borderline fitness freak, who tried to go to extremes.

You know, just push myself to the edge. And as a result, you know, I've accumulated a lot of wear and tear injuries. I have a tear in my left knee, I have a tear on my left shoulder, and I have to always now manage around that.

And there is no, it's not like I had a big fall or I dropped a big weight on me. It's just, you know, wear and tear injury without understanding things. I think earlier Nitin was talking about, you know, how prehab is very important, mobility is very important, recovery is very important, you

know, your weekly massages, myofascial release, you know, trigger point therapy and so on.

So just understanding, I think, the basic fitness is fine. But when you start to push yourself, also understanding, working with a professional trainer, understanding, you know, the limitations of your own body and designing a program, which is, you know, designed to manage injuries. Because, you know, the one bad side of pushing too much is, you know, just accumulate those injuries.

And then sometime, you know, they will stay with you for the rest of your life. Like my injuries now, I have to just manage around that. There's nothing I can do about those.

[Speaker 1] (1:42:30 - 1:43:09)

So as such a popular person, right? Like you are infinitely more popular than us three. Like the three of us are known to 2% of the country.

You're known to maybe 80% of the country. Because Bollywood is humongous, right? How is life?

But it's unfair, no? The share of revenue then, you know, if you see. Actually, it is.

I agree with you. But as a man who has been so popular for so long, we know the hardships, right? Like we discussed it throughout the episode.

Can you tell us some of the perks? And I'm smiling while I ask you this question.

[Speaker 2] (1:43:11 - 1:43:24)

Everything is to do with the brand. And if you hold that brand right, I mean, today, I've probably seen the best phase of my life. You know, monies, respect, everything and anything.

And that doesn't happen anywhere else.

[Speaker 1] (1:43:24 - 1:43:32)

Like how does it feel like you walk into a room and everybody knows you? What is the feeling that you get inside?

[Speaker 2] (1:43:33 - 1:43:41)

Of love. And that's why you continue to do what you're doing. And that's why you want to improve upon yourself because you want to hold on to that legacy.

[Speaker 1] (1:43:42 - 1:44:04)

But I can say this, and I think he would agree at some level as well. I feel like this is when we are

the biggest fans of yours. And this is the coolest phase of your life in a way as well.

Because in many ways, you're probably doing what you truly want to do. Absolutely. No, but Border and Hera Pheri.

[Speaker 3] (1:44:06 - 1:44:06)

I don't know.

[Speaker 1] (1:44:06 - 1:44:29)

I think Hera Pheri was amazing. Border also. I think I cried, right?

So, I mean, like, so there are very few scenes and moments, you know. You know, Nitin was a budding actor growing up. Yeah, like literally.

Like in our room every night, in our bedroom, he would sit and like rehearse. That's why the singing, the guitar, all of that. Okay, I don't want to use cuss words.

[Speaker 2] (1:44:32 - 1:44:33)

It's not too late.

[Speaker 1] (1:44:33 - 1:45:21)

That dream, yeah, it's never too late. I'll tell you what happened, okay. So, there was one Kannada movie.

What happened, I was working out in the gym. And there was a producer who used to work out. And there was a, like one of these villain scenes, villains chasing the girl scene.

And they wanted a few big guys to run behind, you know. And that movie never released, you know. But you did it.

Yeah, I mean, he said, you know, come, come, come. So, I went, you know, like I'm one of the goons running the… But that reminds me of something.

We've been into fitness for a long time. Because we used to have a poster in our bedroom of Rambo, right? Without a shirt on.

And we would have probably posed in front of it a hundred times. I think everyone would have done it.

[Speaker 2] (1:45:22 - 1:45:44)

That's what I said. My martial arts background came from Bruce Lee. And his poster.

That stayed even when we moved homes. I think when they removed that poster, that the paint of, the earlier paint was still there. I'd allowed them to paint the room but not, around it, but not remove the poster.

So, I think we've all… So, what got you into health?

[Speaker 3] (1:45:48 - 1:46:22)

I think it's been a progressive journey. I think there was a, you know, I was always active. Like I grew up playing sports, all kind of sports.

Even in my 20s, I used to play cricket, I got into golf, you know, pretty seriously in my 20s. Around the same time, my roommate, you know, we were both… This guy now runs health cards, Sameer.

So, he was my roommate and he was… I don't think people know him, you know. He was trying to become a model and he was, you know, going to gym regularly.

Within six months, he changed completely. You know, his biceps were like Nitin's bicep and, you know, big chest and all that. And I was, you know…

He's checking you out.

[Speaker 1] (1:46:23 - 1:46:30)

He's so happy. He's checking you out. You know, each time you're posing in a picture, right, he's like this.

[Speaker 3] (1:46:31 - 1:48:22)

He's been sitting like this. So, anyhow, you know, and I was at that time, I was same height, you know, nearly 6 feet and 60 kg. Really skinny.

I was seeing like this guy, you know, all his muscles bulging up and I was feeling like really, really left out. So, after six months of, you know, that, I said, dude, I need to also go to gym with you. So, that's how my fitness journey started.

2007, I moved back to India. And for six months, I had this arrangement wherein I would come here for three weeks, go back, flying economy all the way to US, basically not sleep for 24 hours, spend one week, again come back here for three weeks. And after six months of doing that, I think my, you know, immunity went for a toss.

One of the flight back, I reached, you know, back in Bay Area and I was feeling this weird kind of flu, you know, just this headache just won't go up. I couldn't look into the light. If I move my head around, you know, I will feel everything dizzy.

So, I had to, you know, go to emergency around like 4 a.m. And the doctor had a good sense to think that something is wrong with this person. So, you know, she suspected meningitis. Meningitis is basically infection of spinal fluid, you know, spinal cord and brain.

So, it was, you know, pretty scary, you know, when she told me that you probably have meningitis. It could be viral or bacterial. Bacterial is, can be quite dangerous.

But we wouldn't know for next four days. So, like pretty harrowing four days, you know, I was completely isolated. And eventually it came out viral.

I was a bunch of, you know, medicines and came out of it. But that wasn't a big wake-up call. I was just about 30 at the time.

And just going through that and just four days thinking about all kind of things, you know. Maybe, you know, end is near and all kind of those things. So, I think that was a big wake-up call.

I think from there on, I became, you know, I learned a lot more about generally immunity. That started the whole rabbit hole of looking into fitness and health and food and sleep. And that has been now 15 years, you know, all kind of experimentation, still learning.

But yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:48:22 - 1:48:25)

Nice, nice. Anna, any story from you?

[Speaker 3] (1:48:26 - 1:48:26)

Bruce Lee.

[Speaker 1] (1:48:28 - 1:48:32)

Bruce Lee. Tell us something that you don't often tell people.

[Speaker 2] (1:48:36 - 1:50:23)

Yeah, that I was this little skinny kid. Not too tall. Went in school.

Probably stood number one or two. I'm not talking in class, but in that row. Height-wise.

Height-wise, because it went height-wise. An obsessive cricketer. And wanted to play.

Played great level of cricket in school and otherwise. Scared shit every time I scored, I was worried. I'd have a sleepless night because they'd call me on stage.

And when you went on stage, you were alone there and I was bloody nervous. And when I

decided that I wanted to play serious cricket, I was at the Taj once and I met Sir Vivian Richards. I was a year or two, three years older then.

And when I went and met him and he shook my hand and I put my hand in there, it disappeared. And I had never seen that size of a forearm in my life before. And the automatic choice was, because people always told me if you do weights, you get slower and your height won't grow.

So I asked him, I said, Sir, as an athlete, as a cricketer, why do you have such big arms? Because every cricketer even then was very lean. And of course, when it came to India, there was a lot of potbellies and stuff like that.

But he said to hit harder, son. And that stuck to me. And then I said, you know what, I need to also build that body so that I can, I can hit harder.

So that obsession for hitting harder is what led me to go to the gym.

[Speaker 1] (1:50:26 - 1:50:46)

Nice. Your turn. Turn about.

Say something that, say something that I wouldn't know. Say something deep about your life that even I wouldn't know. Very hard.

On the spot, startup, entrepreneur, what is going on?

[Speaker 4] (1:50:47 - 1:50:47)

Come on.

[Speaker 1] (1:50:48 - 1:52:37)

Very hard to say something that you don't know. 5, 4, 3, 2, 1. No, I think, no, this health topic itself, I think.

What are you most worried about in health? Do you think you'll die before your time? No, no.

I think I'm scared of more about my mind than my body right now. Is it that? No, no.

Mind doesn't, like, just, like, what if I get up tomorrow and I am not motivated to do something in life? What are you not motivated to do right now? No, I'm right now, I'm in a very motivated state.

But I worry sometimes that what if tomorrow morning I get up and I'm not motivated. So, when you wake up every day, what are you most motivated to do today? I mean, there is business, there is Rain Matter, there is Gyan, there is…

Actually, I don't know, there is, I don't know, there is, I can prioritize. I think there is a real answer

and there is an answer you will give me now. So, give me the answer you want to give.

You want me to catch on the camera and then you are pushing me to say some freaking sentimental stuff on the camera. Good way to promote your show, huh? You can cut what you don't like.

No, no, but I think, I think, like, knowing a lot of entrepreneurs, you know, a lot of entrepreneurs look up to us, you know, like how other Bollywood stars might be looking up to us. And there is this illusion that, you know, people who have made it with money are somehow unbreakable. Like, you know, financial success somehow, you know, means mentally they are in a sound place, right?

As in, there is something, I keep talking whenever possible is that, you know, just because we have had financial success doesn't mean that there is no insecurity in life. Now, I am full of insecurities, you know, so, I am sure he is full of insecurities. I have many more.

You know the, I am sorry.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:37 - 1:52:39)

But isn't that, doesn't that bring about stability?

[Speaker 1] (1:52:40 - 1:53:30)

Insecurity? No, financial stability. No, no, but the thing, you know, what I am saying is people think money solves all life problems.

Yeah, oh yeah, of course. So, you know, and I have realized more money has just complicated our lives. Of course, it has given us the freedom to do what we want to do.

But more money just, you know, just the way people think of you as a person, you know, everything changes. So, we are very different with money. I don't think, how do I put this?

I am more businessman like, he is more startup founder like. Does that make sense? Is that fair?

So, the thing, money doesn't, like, you know, like, it's not like he is spending the money. But he enjoys making the money. I enjoy more like getting the love.

In the sense, you know, like, you know, people…

[Speaker 2] (1:53:30 - 1:53:35)

Seeing people, the growth, someone else's growth, the startup that you back, the high of giving.

[Speaker 1] (1:53:36 - 1:53:58)

I mean, in a sense. In a way, yeah, I mean, not only that, like, you know, like, I am very, I interact with our customers quite a bit, you know, so on a bunch of forums. When someone says something good, you know, like, I am so excited.

Like, that excitement doesn't, money doesn't bring it anymore. I mean, it used to bring at one point. I think I kind of hit that point where beyond a certain point, money stopped mattering, you know, making a difference to the life.

Thank God, you didn't take up acting then.

[Speaker 2] (1:53:58 - 1:53:59)

You won't survive.

[Speaker 1] (1:54:01 - 1:58:35)

Okay, so, I will start. So, you guys can say what I do or something similar. What I am doing for my health now is, my biggest issue is I can't sleep.

Because I start work early and I work out late in the night. I struggle with 5 hours, 5 and a half hours. But the new thing I learnt from Huberman, I sit in this balcony, stare at the sun for 20 minutes while I am reading a book.

Every morning, 20-30 minutes. I do intermittent fasting. So, I don't eat for 16 hours.

First meal is at 2 pm. I have a coffee before that at 11. First meal, I have an agey one.

Then I have fish oil. I have vitamin D. And in the night, when I work out, I have an LMNT.

And then I have a protein shake after my workout. And then I go to bed. I don't know if it's working or not.

We will find out someday. But that's what I am doing. I think, like, what has worked for me and has remained consistent over the last 2-3 years in terms of fitness has been getting up early and getting it done first thing in the morning.

Because I have realized that every time I postpone it, some distraction comes. It never happens. So, second is, like I said earlier, just getting work out early means my food choices for the day are almost always much better.

I find playing a sport very relaxing. So, I try to get a game of some sport every week, at least once or twice. This habit of an activity tracker, I think, has just been brilliant.

Like today, activity trackers are available for 3-4 thousand rupees. So, you know, I have like a calorie tracking. So, it keeps going on.

So, I am accountable at the end of every night, saying that I have moved this much at least. So, that is in terms of, and then having a hobby. So, I play the guitar, I sing a bit.

I am always constantly trying to learn some new skill set. In terms of nutrition, I experiment. So, I don't know if I should be sharing every single thing that I am experimenting with.

But right now, my cycle, what I am doing right now is I get up and have a coffee in the morning. First thing, black coffee. This wires me for the workout.

I am having, we both are having athletic greens. I am having vitamin D, omega, multivitamins. Ag1 multivitamins both?

They are the same thing? I mean, this is what I endow as given. Then, a whey protein after the workout.

And usually, I make sure I have 3 full meals and each of the meal is balanced. So, there is protein. One of the hacks that I have realized is because I have the habit of eating too much, I always start with some salad.

So, there is always some green that goes and kind of fills me up. So, you know, it is like a hack I have found for myself. Super salad before the meal.

Yeah, super salad before the meal. And I have a dessert problem. So, luckily, you know, because of that, ditch the guilt startup that we are supporting.

Now, I get my special job. All the call center sales skills are coming out. Yeah, so, yeah, I think that.

And generally, I think mental health is something I care about quite a bit. And we keep discussing about it. It is just not to keep anything in my mind.

He is very good at that. I will just, you know, anything that is bothering me, I make sure before I sleep. I will tell you a story.

So, I used to be, how do I describe this in a nice way? I used to date a girl. And lockdown was going on, whatever.

And we both were in one house together. It was a long time, lockdown. And we had broken up at that point of time.

So, Nitin's advice to me, right? I am going through a breakup. We are getting reasonably intoxicated every night for two months.

We have both put on 5 kilos each. And he is like, you have to cry. You don't have to mean it.

Do drama.

[Speaker 4] (1:58:36 - 1:58:38)

No, it is not drama.

[Speaker 1] (1:58:38 - 1:59:16)

I said, you need to talk it out. I said, if you talk it out, you will cry. No, it was not that.

He is like, just pretend to cry. No, but I think, this whole being authentic, what he is talking about. I think from the time I have started doing that, I think I have maxed, two things that has brought freedom to my life.

One is, of course, money, etc. But second is this. Just not keeping anything in your mind.

Just getting it out there. It doesn't matter. Because you postpone it, it is just complicated.

I think these are all my life hacks.

[Speaker 2] (1:59:16 - 2:02:05)

I think, you know, what you said now is something that, I think I have been practicing for the last 7-8 years, and it worked like magic. It is the time factor. Whenever something disturbed me, I understood how long that stayed with me.

And the hack was to reduce that amount of time. The next time something happened, I tried to reduce that amount of time, and then I said, I am going to forget about it. Now I think I have reached a stage where I can instantly, instantly in the sense, in a day or two, you know, say, you know what, it doesn't matter to me, and I am not going to take care of, I am not going to worry about it.

It has happened. You know, I realized that whether it is any form of fitness, I have done that. I have been there and done that.

It has been given a new term now, you know, because you don't have that strength. So, get into the zone, where I am comfortable doing what I am doing, and not being complexed by anybody. Nobody's arms, nobody's bicep, nobody's triceps, nobody's abs, you know, unnerve me, or am I jealous of, I am comfortable in my own space.

And I am very, very, very clear that 90% of them are not as pure as I am. Purity from a point of view of abusing myself from a health perspective. No other way.

So, that is my USP, and that is what I am working on, because I know I might extend that process of aging a lot more than others might be able to. So, keeping things simple, and I have realized

that the simpler I am keeping things, it is working like magic for me. Whether it is the way I look, or the way I behave, or my physique, the physical structure, I said, let it be all natural.

And in today's world, of the virtual world, the more honest you are, and the more you accept, and say, yes, this is something I don't have. Because this generation, if nothing else, is a very, very honest generation. Corruption is something that they'd never be able to handle.

I mean, I can't imagine my kids going to someone and saying, Sir, yeh chahiye, jugad. Jugad? They say, Papa, what jugad?

So, I think I've picked up all this from them, and that's why I've become far more confident also. You know, I'm someone who says, I will not resort to all this. So, I think these are the things that I've taken from others, and I guess also started believing and appreciating others for what they're achieving, what they're doing, rather than just cinema, cinema, movie, success, failure.

I think a lot of other things. And post-pandemic, even more so. Right.

[Speaker 3] (2:02:06 - 2:02:32)

Outstanding. I think, for my health, for me, health is both, I think, a lifestyle choice, but also a very strong hobby. I just enjoy this space a lot.

So, a lot of things I do, they're not necessarily because they're going to make me healthy. So, with that caveat, you know what, I sleep at 9. Today, I'm not going to sleep at 9.

Thank you. But I enjoy the conversation.

[Speaker 1] (2:02:32 - 2:02:40)

Thank you. Have we reached interval time yet? Halfway is done?

No, no. We'll finish in the next 3 hours.

[Speaker 3] (2:02:44 - 2:04:36)

So, I generally sleep at 9. Get up at 5. I'm in the gym by 6.

Before that, I do some meditation, etc. Something, you know, just prime myself, think through what matters to me that day. I try to spend 2 hours in the gym.

Doesn't mean I work out for 2 hours, including your warm-up. I'll just walk leisurely on a treadmill for some time. A little bit loiter around.

Just, you know, get the vibes of the gym. Think about, you know, things. At some point, get into a proper workout.

Post that, I try to do some meditation or yoga every single day. Around 8, I'm out and I get, you know, my first meal of the day, 8.30. Along with supplements, I take a bunch of supplements. A lot of them, I have no idea whether they're doing something good for me or not.

I check my blood work every 3 months religiously. It's like, you know, 20-page report I get. Most of the numbers also don't move.

And if they move, they are mostly noisy. But I like it, you know, that's become part of habit. My second meal of the day is around 3 p.m. So, usually, you know, I'll be in a meeting and somebody will bring my food and I'll just, 3 p.m. sharp, I'll eat and basically I'm done with that. So, that gives around 16-17 hours of fasting. I'm pretty big on a lot of, you know, these wellness therapies. So, we talked about heat and sauna.

I think they're part of my weekly schedule. Massages, you know, different type of myofascial releases. Just experimenting with different things.

I try to go out of my way and try something new. Right now, trying to figure out how to get into, you know, aerial yoga. So, I think that's the new thing, you know, that I was trying to do Pilates, you know.

Just very beginner, basic level, about 6 months ago. And so on, generally experimenting. I think one thing that I really, really want to work on and not able to make a lot of progress on is just really having deep meditative time, you know, throughout the day.

My ideal setup will be an hour in the morning.

[Speaker 4] (2:04:36 - 2:04:36)

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (2:04:37 - 2:05:07)

And then few times during the day, I'm doing, you know, these different pranayama practices. Like, after 2 hours, when, like, you know, I take my break, I would love to do 5 minutes of some kind of, you know, alternate nostril breathing or Vastrika or, you know, there's now so many, you know, different names being given. But they're all, you know, conditioning your lungs and regulating a lot of your body metabolism.

Again, in the evening, have a, like, 30 to 45 minutes of wind down reflection about the day. I'm not able to do, but that's something I'm actively working on. I think, hopefully, get there this year.

Super. Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:07 - 2:05:15)

No, I think that's it for tonight. Thank you everyone for coming. Anna, thank you so much for flying down all the way from Bombay.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:15 - 2:05:15)

Not at all. Pleasure. Pleasure.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:15 - 2:05:20)

Mukesh, sorry for pulling your leg a little bit in the beginning. Hopefully, I made up for it eventually.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:20 - 2:05:23)

You more than made up for it and absolutely all cool.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:23 - 2:05:29)

Him, I don't have to say anything. So, thank you everyone. See you next time.